

D822

Technology Governance

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

At a regional bank with 60 branches, the IT director has been deciding how much cyber risk the bank will accept and which strategic IT investments to fund. The board meets quarterly in a renovated boardroom. Which change best aligns with sound technology governance?

- A. Have the board meet monthly instead of quarterly.
- B. Have the board take over daily IT operations.
- C. Keep the IT director deciding, since he knows the technology best.
- D. The board sets risk appetite and investment direction, and the IT director manages execution within them.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which activity is management rather than governance?

- A. Every IT decision is management.
- B. Reviewing whether IT investments delivered promised value.
- C. Scheduling server patching and assigning engineers to it.
- D. Approving the enterprise's risk appetite.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A retail chain's board, which includes two former marketing executives, says it cannot tell whether \$40 million in annual IT spending supports business goals. Which framework is designed for this concern?

- A. COBIT
- B. CMMI
- C. ISO/IEC 27001
- D. ITIL

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

An online store's checkout crashed for the third time this month during a sale. Each time, engineers restarted the server within 15 minutes. The site was redesigned last spring. Which ITIL practice should now take the lead?

- A. Change enablement, to approve the redesign.
- B. Problem management, to find and remove the root cause.
- C. Incident management, since restarts restore service.
- D. Service desk, to log more tickets.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Problem management found that a memory leak causes the crashes, and a code fix is ready. Which ITIL practice governs deploying the fix to production?

- A. Problem management, which deploys its own fixes.
- B. Change enablement
- C. No process; urgent fixes skip review.
- D. Incident management

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A software firm with offices in three countries has written organization-wide standard processes that every project tailors from. It does not yet use statistical process data to manage performance. Its CEO has a PhD. What CMMI maturity level best fits?

- A. Level 2 — Managed
- B. Level 5 — Optimizing, because standards exist.
- C. Level 3 — Defined
- D. Level 4 — Quantitatively Managed

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A team plans and tracks each project's requirements and schedules, but each project does it differently and there is no company standard. What must the organization add to reach the next CMMI level?

- A.** Organization-wide standard processes that projects tailor.
- B.** Continuous innovation programs.
- C.** Basic project planning.
- D.** Statistical process control.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A health insurer with a new mobile app wants an independent certification showing it runs a formal information security management system. Its app has 2 million downloads. Which standard fits?

- A.** ISO/IEC 38500
- B.** ISO/IEC 20000-1
- C.** ISO/IEC 27001
- D.** ISO 9001

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A cloud migration RACI chart lists the CIO, the CFO, and the infrastructure manager all as "Accountable" for approving the cutover date. The chart uses the company's blue template. What is wrong?

- A.** Only one role should be Accountable; the others can be Consulted or Responsible.
- B.** The template color should match the IT brand.
- C.** Nothing; shared accountability improves buy-in.
- D.** There should be no Responsible roles.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

In a RACI row for “deploy firewall rule,” a network engineer does the work, the security manager signs off and answers for the result, the app owner gives input, and the help desk is told afterward. Which role is Accountable?

- A.** The app owner
- B.** The security manager
- C.** The help desk
- D.** The network engineer

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

An IT steering committee has \$5 million and requests totaling \$9 million. The sales VP, the company’s longest-serving executive, demands her CRM upgrade go first. What should guide the ranking?

- A.** Fund requests in the order received.
- B.** Fund every project at 56% of its request.
- C.** Fund the CRM first because of the VP’s tenure.
- D.** Score each request on alignment with strategy, expected value, and risk, and fund the highest.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A university outsources student records to a cloud vendor with a glossy sales deck. The vendor suffers a breach exposing 30,000 records. The provost says the vendor alone is responsible. What is the governance view?

- A.** The university is accountable only if more than 50,000 records leaked.
- B.** No one is responsible because breaches are unavoidable.
- C.** The vendor alone is responsible, since the contract moved the duty.
- D.** The university remains accountable to students and regulators, even though the vendor did the work.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer D Concept 1

At a regional bank ~~with 60 branches~~, the IT director has been deciding how much cyber risk the bank will accept and which strategic IT investments to fund. The board meets quarterly ~~in a renovated boardroom~~. Which change best aligns with sound technology governance?

Target word: who sets direction and risk appetite **Decides:** Risk appetite and strategic direction are governance duties.

A	Wrong stem number	Meeting frequency does not fix who decides.
B	Adjacent category	Pulls governance into management work.
C	Inverted operation	Places a governance duty with management.
D	Correct	Governance evaluates, directs, and monitors; management executes.

2. Answer C Concept 1 • transfer

Which activity is management rather than governance?

Target word: reverse identification **Decides:** Executing and running work is management.

A	Absolute language	Direction-setting decisions belong to governance.
B	Confusion set	Board-level monitoring is governance.
C	Correct	Plan-build-run work is management.
D	Inverted operation	A governance decision.

3. Answer A Concept 2

A retail chain's board, ~~which includes two former marketing executives~~, says it cannot tell whether \$40 million in annual IT spending supports business goals. Which framework is designed for this concern?

Target word: choose framework **Decides:** Board-level alignment and value from I&T.

A	Correct	Aligns enterprise and IT goals and addresses value, risk, and resources.
B	Confusion set	Focuses on process maturity.
C	Adjacent category	A security management standard.
D	Confusion set	Focuses on managing IT services, not board alignment.

4. Answer B Concept 3

An online store's checkout crashed for the third time this month during a sale. Each time, engineers restarted the server within 15 minutes. ~~The site was redesigned last spring~~. Which ITIL practice should now take the lead?

Target word: incident vs. problem **Decides:** Recurring failure needs root-cause work.

A	Camouflage	The redesign is past and not shown to be the cause.
B	Correct	Repeat incidents signal an underlying problem.
C	Dropped element	Restores service but leaves the cause.
D	Adjacent category	Logging alone does not remove the cause.

5. Answer B Concept 3 · transfer

Problem management found that a memory leak causes the crashes, and a code fix is ready. Which ITIL practice governs deploying the fix to production?

Target word: next practice after root cause **Decides:** A production modification goes through change enablement.

A	Inverted operation	Problem management identifies fixes; changes are controlled separately.
B	Correct	Assesses and authorizes changes to reduce risk.
C	Absolute language	Emergency changes still go through an expedited path.
D	Confusion set	Restores service; it does not authorize changes.

6. Answer C Concept 4

A software firm ~~with offices in three countries~~ has written organization-wide standard processes that every project tailors from. It does not yet use statistical process data to manage performance. ~~Its CEO has a PhD.~~ What CMMI maturity level best fits?

Target word: identify level **Decides:** Organization-wide standards, no quantitative management.

A	Confusion set	Processes managed per project, not organization-wide.
B	Absolute language	Skips two levels of requirements.
C	Correct	Organization-wide standard processes define level 3.
D	Adjacent category	Requires statistical management, which is missing.

7. Answer A Concept 4 · transfer

A team plans and tracks each project's requirements and schedules, but each project does it differently and there is no company standard. What must the organization add to reach the next CMMI level?

Target word: solve for next step **Decides:** From level 2 to 3: organization-wide standard processes.

A	Correct	Moves from Managed (2) to Defined (3).
B	Confusion set	Level 5 focus.
C	Inverted operation	Already in place; that is level 2.
D	Adjacent category	A level 4 requirement; skips level 3.

8. Answer C Concept 5

A health insurer with a new mobile app wants an independent certification showing it runs a formal information security management system. ~~Its app has 2 million downloads.~~ Which standard fits?

Target word: choose the ISO standard **Decides:** Certifiable security management system.

A	Confusion set	Principles for board governance of IT, not a security system.
B	Confusion set	IT service management.
C	Correct	The certifiable information security management system standard.
D	Adjacent category	Quality management.

9. Answer A Concept 6

A cloud migration RACI chart lists the CIO, the CFO, and the infrastructure manager all as “Accountable” for approving the cutover date. ~~The chart uses the company’s blue template.~~ What is wrong?

Target word: RACI rule **Decides:** Exactly one Accountable per activity.

A	Correct	Shared accountability means no one is truly accountable.
B	Camouflage	Irrelevant to RACI rules.
C	Inverted operation	Dilutes ownership.
D	Adjacent category	Responsible roles do the work and can be many.

10. Answer B Concept 6 • transfer

In a RACI row for “deploy firewall rule,” a network engineer does the work, the security manager signs off and answers for the result, the app owner gives input, and the help desk is told afterward. Which role is Accountable?

Target word: assign the A **Decides:** The one who signs off and answers for the result.

A	Confusion set	Gives input: Consulted.
B	Correct	Owens and answers for the outcome.
C	Inverted operation	Told afterward: Informed.
D	Confusion set	Does the work: Responsible.

11. Answer D Concept 7

An IT steering committee has \$5 million and requests totaling \$9 million. The sales VP, ~~the company’s longest-serving executive,~~ demands her CRM upgrade go first. What should guide the ranking?

Target word: portfolio prioritization **Decides:** Strategic alignment, value, and risk.

A	Adjacent category	Arrival order ignores value.
B	Wrong stem number	\$5M/\$9M spread evenly ignores priority.
C	Camouflage	Seniority is not value.
D	Correct	Portfolio governance ranks by value and fit.

12. Answer D Concept 8

A university outsources student records to a cloud vendor ~~with a glossy sales deck.~~ The vendor suffers a breach exposing 30,000 records. The provost says the vendor alone is responsible. What is the governance view?

Target word: accountability **Decides:** Tasks can be outsourced; accountability cannot.

A	Wrong stem number	No such threshold.
B	Absolute language	Ignores oversight duties.
C	Inverted operation	Contracts shift tasks, not ultimate accountability.
D	Correct	Leadership keeps accountability for outcomes and oversight.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owled.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	1	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	3	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	8	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	7	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	4	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	10	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	3	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Governance vs. management	Governance (the board and top leadership) evaluates options, sets direction, and monitors performance; management plans, builds, runs, and monitors activities within that direction.	Treating governance as day-to-day IT operations, or letting IT managers set enterprise risk appetite.	Who sets direction and approves vs. who executes.
2	COBIT's aim: value from I&T	COBIT is a governance framework for enterprise information and technology that aligns IT goals to stakeholder needs through benefits realization, risk optimization, and resource optimization.	Thinking COBIT is an IT service desk process library or a security certification.	Board-level alignment of IT to enterprise goals.
3	ITIL: incident, problem, change	Incident management restores service fast; problem management finds and removes root causes; change enablement controls modifications to reduce risk.	Treating a quick workaround as solving the problem.	Restore now vs. find the cause vs. approve a modification.
4	CMMI maturity levels	Levels: 1 Initial (ad hoc), 2 Managed (project-level), 3 Defined (organization-wide standards), 4 Quantitatively Managed (measured with statistics), 5 Optimizing (continuous improvement).	Confusing Managed (level 2) with Quantitatively Managed (level 4), or Defined with Managed.	Whether processes are per-project, organization-wide, measured, or continuously improved.
5	Which ISO standard covers what	ISO/IEC 27001 = information security management system; ISO/IEC 20000-1 = IT service management system; ISO/IEC 38500 = principles for board governance of IT; ISO 9001 = quality management.	Citing 27001 for service management or 38500 for security controls.	The goal named: security, service, board governance, or quality.
6	RACI: one accountable party	In a RACI matrix, many can be Responsible, Consulted, or Informed, but exactly one role is Accountable for each activity.	Assigning shared accountability to a committee or several roles.	Two or more A's in one row.
7	Portfolio prioritization by business value	An IT steering committee ranks initiatives by alignment with strategy, value, and risk, not by who asks loudest or which tech is newest.	Funding projects first-come, first-served or by departmental clout.	More requests than budget.
8	Accountability cannot be outsourced	Organizations can outsource IT tasks, but leadership remains accountable for ethical, legal, and social outcomes, including data protection.	Assuming a vendor contract transfers responsibility for a breach or unethical use.	A vendor or cloud provider in a failure scenario.

Course scope (public description): Technology Governance equips students with strategic frameworks and practices essential for effective governance in technology. The course covers the entire lifecycle of technology governance, including establishing governance structures and leadership techniques for enforcing these frameworks. Key themes include the evaluation of various technology governance models, the development of IT leadership skills, and the strategic integration of technology to meet business objectives. The course is aligned with COBIT, ITIL, CMMI, and ISO frameworks, emphasizing their application in real-world scenarios. Ethical considerations and social responsibility in technological governance are also explored.